

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

people who have pulled themselves from a difficult financial situation at great personal cost, only to end up in the same situation again a little while later – because they hadn't dealt with or accepted the factors that got them to that point in the first place. In fact, I too had also tried to fix the superficial problem without properly getting over the mistakes that I'd made, and it didn't work for me either. Any progress felt laboured, like I was pulling on a stiff elastic band, and I knew that it would need to spring back at some point. And then, of course, it always did, and I would find myself back at square one.

It's worth noting that this doesn't only apply to big financial mistakes. Sometimes it's only the smallest thing keeping us locked in those limiting beliefs about ourselves – that we're 'bad with money', that we 'just don't get it' etc. It might be the fact that you still have your student overdraft in your thirties, or that you once borrowed a fiver from a colleague and didn't pay it back, or that you were talked into an extortionate car finance arrangement on a brand new model when you were just looking for something to get you from A to B. It could be anything.

Before we get into this properly, I just want you to know that absolutely EVERYBODY makes mistakes with money, and if I'm honest, a large component in how big of a deal they are, or how ashamed we feel about them, is a little thing called wealth privilege. In other words, some people are just more comfortable with messing up with money than others,